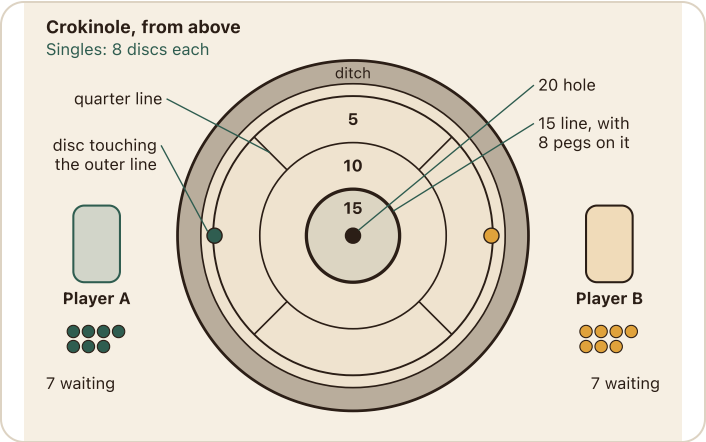
THE LUDARIUM · TEACH SHEET

Teach Crokinole in ten minutes

2 or 4 (singles or doubles) players · 10 to 20 minutes for a four-round game; races to 100 run longer · All ages; small kids can shoot from closer in

The goal: Score more than the other side each round by leaving discs near the center and knocking theirs off.



On your turn

1. Shoot one disc per turn, clockwise around the board.
2. Start it flat, touching the outer line in your own quarter.
3. Flick with a finger. Only your shooting hand, wrist, and forearm may touch the board.
4. If an opponent has a disc on the board, you must hit one, directly or by combination.
5. If none are on the board, a disc must end touching or inside the 15 line.
6. A failed shot: remove the shooter and every disc it struck.
7. A disc touching or crossing the outer line goes to the ditch.
8. Pull out any 20 right away and keep it in view.

Three tips for your first game

1. Shoot softer than you think. A hit that stays on the board beats a hit that flies off.
2. Count shots left. The last shot of the round, the hammer, is a big edge.
3. With no target to hit, stop just touching the 15 line behind a peg. It counts, and it is hard to hit.

Setup

1. Two players sit across the board. Four players form two teams, partners across from each other.
2. Each side takes one color: 8 discs each in singles, 6 each in doubles.
3. Put a pinch of powder in the ditch. Players rub discs in it, not on the board.
4. Decide who shoots first. The start alternates every round.

Scoring

- Center hole: 20. Inside the 15 line: 15. Then 10, then 5.
- A disc touching a line scores the lower region.
- Count before anyone touches a disc.
- Tournament: round win 2 points, tie 1 each, four rounds per game.
- Home: higher total scores the difference, first to 100 wins.

Game end: A round ends when every disc is shot. A tournament game is four rounds; a home game usually runs until one side reaches 100.

Free to print and share. Free course: theludarium.com/academy/crokinole/

Unofficial. Not affiliated with the National Crokinole Association, the World Crokinole Championship, or any board maker. Crokinole is a traditional folk game with no single publisher. Rules as of the Official Rules of Crokinole, National Crokinole Association (ratified May 6, 2026), checked against the World Crokinole Championship rules (Tavistock, Ontario).